

MONOLOGUE - ESTHER SAQUSAQU

The Miracle of Laughter

based on the life of Sarah as recorded in Genesis chapters 18 and 21

Character: Sarah (Age 90)

Setting: The plains of Mamre, outside a tent.

Prop: A small bowl and a cloth (for "cleaning" while speaking).

[THE PERFORMANCE]

(Sarah is sitting on a small stool. She is vigorously scrubbing a bowl with a cloth. She looks toward an imaginary tent stage-left and shakes her head, talking to the audience as if they are her friends sitting nearby.)

Did you hear that? I know I'm ninety, but my hearing is still perfectly fine! Abraham is in that tent right now with three visitors—special visitors—and I just heard the most ridiculous thing I've ever heard in my nearly ten decades on this earth.

(She stops scrubbing and leans in close, whispering)

They said that *I*... Sarah... am going to have a son. A baby! Next year!

(She lets out a short, dry laugh and goes back to scrubbing)

I couldn't help it. I laughed! I tried to do it silently into my sleeve, but it just bubbled up. A baby? At ninety? Most people my age are worried about where they put their walking stick, not where they put the cradle. I've spent my whole life waiting for a child. I've watched the seasons change, the tents move, and the gray hairs multiply. That ship didn't just sail; it's been at the bottom of the Red Sea for forty years!

(She stands up, agitated, and paces a few steps)

But then, one of the men asked a question. He didn't sound angry, but his voice... it had a weight to it. Like the sound of thunder before a rainstorm. He asked: "*Why did Sarah laugh? Is anything too hard for the Lord?*"

(She freezes. The humor leaves her face. She looks down at her hands, which are shaking slightly.)

I was terrified. I actually tried to deny it! I said, "I didn't laugh." But He looked right into my soul and said, "No, but you *did* laugh."

And in that moment, the humor turned into something else. It turned into a question that I've been running away from for a long time. Is anything—*anything*—too hard for the Lord?

I've spent ninety years looking at what was "possible." I looked at my age. I looked at my tired bones. I looked at the biology books. And all I saw were "No's." But God wasn't looking at my "No's." He was looking at His "Yes."

(She sits back down, her expression softening into a peaceful smile)

He waited until it was impossible so that no one—not even the skeptics in the next tribe over—could say this was an accident. He waited until all I had left was a laugh of disbelief, just so He could turn it into a laugh of pure joy.

(She looks toward the tent again, her eyes bright)

Abraham is already in there naming the baby in his head. He wants to name him Isaac. Do you know what that means? It means "*Laughter*." Every time I call that boy for dinner, I'll be reminded of the day I laughed behind a tent flap. I'll be reminded that God isn't limited by our calendars or our gray hair. He is the God of the impossible.

(She stands up, looks up toward the sky, and speaks with conviction)

So, let the neighbors whisper. Let them wonder how an old woman can carry a child. I'll just keep on laughing. Not because I don't believe... but because I finally do.

(She picks up her bowl, smiles broadly, and exits stage-right with a slight skip in her step.)

Performance Tips for the 4-Minute Mark:

1. **The "Listen" (30 seconds):** Before the first line, spend time "eavesdropping." React with your face to what is being said in the tent. This builds the character and adds time.
2. **The "Shift" (Middle):** When Sarah says "Is anything too hard for the Lord?", slow down significantly. Let the silence hang for 3-5 seconds. This shows the judges "emotional range."
3. **The Exit:** Don't rush off. Walk off with the same "old but happy" energy she had during the last line.